

May

14

1796

First vaccine

British doctor Edward Jenner injected eight-year-old James Phipps with pus taken from the blisters of a milkmaid infected with cowpox. The vaccine gave the child immunity (resistance) against a similar but much more deadly disease called smallpox.



Born this day

1984 Mark Zuckerberg, US tech innovator and entrepreneur. He co-founded the social media site Facebook while still a student at Harvard University, USA.



Fantastic flip

Brazilian surfer Gabriel Medina stunned spectators and surfing fans around the world by landing the first-ever backflip in a competition, earning a perfect score of 10 from the judges.

2016

Also on this day

1918 The practice of observing a two-minute silence originated on this day, when people in Cape Town, South Africa, stood still to remember those killed in World War I.

1948 A new and independent Jewish state called Israel was established, after the United Nations (UN) divided Palestine between Jews and Arabs.

1955 The Soviet Union and countries in Eastern Europe signed the Warsaw Pact, a military alliance against external attacks.

Bear in danger

2008

Following a legal campaign

by environmentalists, the polar bear was finally listed as “threatened” in the USA, signalling that action was needed to protect the Arctic species. Polar bears are at risk because climate change is melting their sea-ice habitat.

